

Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7) — Paper 5

Chapter 17: India, a Home to Many

Paper 5 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	17 — India, a Home to Many
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Apex traps: filing a refuge or enslaved arrival under 'trade'; collapsing Islam's peaceful 7th-century Arab-merchant arrival into the much later military invasions; reading identity-preserving integration as either total assimilation or total apartness; chaining several distinctions at once (refuge vs opportunity vs enslavement; immigrant vs emigrant; persecution vs refuge; cosmopolitan vs pluralism vs tolerance vs ethos; prophet Zarathushtra vs God Ahura Mazda; matching synagogue/fire temple/church/mosque to the right community); and treating diversity as a weakness rather than the chapter's source of strength, in the spirit of vasudhaiva kutumbakam. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. A student builds this chain of reasoning: 'India received community X for over a thousand years; X kept its own house of worship; therefore India must have forced X to live entirely apart.' Every link is sound except the conclusion. The flaw is that keeping a distinct place of worship actually evidences:

- (A) integration into Indian society while retaining a separate identity, not enforced separation
- (B) that the community was compelled to abandon its faith to be accepted
- (C) that the community ruled over the older inhabitants from its own quarter
- (D) that India received the community only in modern times, not for a thousand years

2. Order these by the EARLIEST point at which the chapter says each began arriving in India, from oldest to most recent: the Tibetan refugees, the Arab merchants, the enslavement of the Siddis. The correct sequence is:

- (A) Arab merchants (7th century), Siddis (from around the 7th century onward), Tibetan refugees (1950s)
- (B) Tibetan refugees, then Arab merchants, then the Siddis
- (C) Siddis (19th century), then Arab merchants (7th century), then Tibetans (1950s)
- (D) Arab merchants (7th century), then Tibetans (1950s), then the Siddis (still earlier)

3. A debater claims India should expel newcomers 'to keep its culture pure.' The chapter's single strongest rebuttal pairs a value with concrete evidence. That pairing is:

- (A) vasudhaiva kutumbakam, backed by borrowed foods, words, crafts, music and faiths that made Indian culture richer
- (B) atithi devo bhava, backed by newcomers being required to drop their own customs
- (C) tolerance, backed by the Siddis being kept apart as a separate tribe
- (D) pluralism, backed by India expelling communities once their usefulness ended

4. Four motives are listed: the Parsi flight from Persia, the Armenian trade ventures, the Siddi arrival, the Polish children's escape during war. Grouped correctly, these are:

- (A) all four came for opportunity through trade
- (B) Parsis and Armenians fled danger; Polish children and Siddis came for opportunity
- (C) Parsis, Armenians and Polish children all fled danger; the Siddis came for trade
- (D) Parsis and Polish children fled danger (refuge); Armenians came for opportunity; the Siddis were brought enslaved

5. Why does the chapter treat 'Islam came peacefully with Arab traders' and 'Islam came through later invasions' as two SEPARATE events rather than one?

- (A) because the invasions came first and the peaceful trade followed much later
- (B) the peaceful trading arrival on the west coast began in the 7th century, centuries before the later military invasions
- (C) because the peaceful arrival never actually happened, leaving only the invasions
- (D) because both happened at the same moment and differ only in how they are described

6. India's oldest mosque on the west coast functions in the chapter as physical proof of a claim. That claim is best stated as:

- (A) Arab merchants seized the west coast by force of arms
- (B) a religion can take root through early peaceful trade and settlement, not only through later conquest
- (C) the freed Siddis built mosques after their enslavement ended
- (D) the Parsis adopted Islam soon after reaching Gujarat

7. The Mappila and the Siddi communities both ENTERED Indian life through coastal contact with outsiders, yet differ sharply in how each began. The key contrast is that the Mappila:

- (A) were brought enslaved, whereas the Siddis were free wealthy traders
- (B) and the Siddis both began as armies that conquered the coast
- (C) and the Siddis both formed when refugees fled religious persecution
- (D) arose from free Arab traders who settled and married locally, whereas the Siddis were brought enslaved

8. The Siddi story moves from enslaved arrival to recognition as a scheduled tribe. Read at the level of the chapter's main argument, this trajectory most powerfully shows that India:

- (A) welcomed only those communities that arrived freely as traders or refugees
- (B) permanently kept enslaved-origin communities outside its society
- (C) extended the protections of Indian society even to a community that arrived without any choice
- (D) granted protection only after a community proved its usefulness in trade

9. A 'scheduled tribe', as the chapter applies the term to the Siddis, is best defined as a community that is:

- (A) a foreign trading guild granted special tax privileges
- (B) barred by law from settling anywhere in India
- (C) officially recognised by the Constitution for special support and protection
- (D) a ruling dynasty holding authority over an Indian state

10. Consider the Cochin Jews, the Syriac Christians and the Parsis. A student asks what single sentence is true of ALL THREE without being true of the Siddis. That sentence is:

- (A) they were brought to India enslaved and later freed
- (B) they fled the dangers of a 20th-century war
- (C) they each abandoned their original religion soon after settling
- (D) they came of their own accord and preserved their own faith while joining Indian society

11. A precise statement about Zoroastrianism must get three things right at once: its age, its God, and its core teaching. The fully correct statement is:

- (A) one of the world's newest religions, worshipping many gods of nature
- (B) a branch of Judaism centred on the synagogue and the choice of good over evil
- (C) one of the world's oldest religions, worshipping the prophet Zarathushtra as God
- (D) one of the world's oldest religions, worshipping the one God Ahura Mazda and stressing the choice of good over evil

12. A student writes, 'The Parsis worship Zarathushtra, the God who created their fire temples.' Two errors are embedded here. Correcting both gives:

- (A) Zarathushtra is indeed the God, but the fire temples were built by Ahura Mazda
- (B) the Parsis worship many gods of nature, with Zarathushtra the chief among them

- (C) Zarathushtra was the human prophet, not God; the God worshipped is Ahura Mazda, and the Parsis built the fire temples themselves
- (D) Ahura Mazda was the prophet and Zarathushtra the God who founded the fire temples

13. The chapter associates a region and a marker with each refugee community. For the Parsis and the Cochin Jews respectively, the correct pairing is:

- (A) Parsis with Kerala and their synagogues; Cochin Jews with their fire temples
- (B) Parsis with Gujarat and their fire temples; Cochin Jews with their synagogues
- (C) Parsis with Tibet and their monasteries; Cochin Jews with their churches
- (D) Parsis with Armenia and their churches; Cochin Jews with their monasteries

14. Match each house of worship to its community in a single correct set: synagogue, fire temple, church, oldest mosque. The correct matching is:

- (A) synagogue to the Jews, fire temple to the Parsis, church to Christians such as the Armenians, oldest mosque to the Arab merchants
- (B) synagogue to the Parsis, fire temple to the Jews, church to the Siddis, mosque to the Tibetans
- (C) synagogue to the Arab merchants, fire temple to the Armenians, church to the Parsis, mosque to the Jews
- (D) synagogue to the Christians, fire temple to the Arab merchants, church to the Jews, mosque to the Parsis

15. Sowa Rigpa's entry into India's AYUSH programme is used in the chapter to refute one particular misconception. That misconception is:

- (A) that India ever sheltered refugees in the first place
- (B) that Sowa Rigpa is a religion rather than a system of medicine
- (C) that welcoming refugees adds nothing to, or even weakens, the host culture
- (D) that the Tibetans came to India seeking trade rather than refuge

16. The Good Maharaja's shelter of Polish children connects most directly to one other example in the chapter, and the reason matters. That example and reason are:

- (A) the Arab merchants, because both involved coming to India for trade
- (B) the Tibetan refugees, because both are cases of giving shelter to people fleeing danger
- (C) the Siddis, because both involved people brought to India enslaved
- (D) the Armenians, because both involved building churches in India

17. A newcomer reports: 'I left my homeland because I was attacked for my beliefs, and here I was given shelter.' Using the chapter's vocabulary precisely, she has, in order:

- (A) emigrated from her homeland and immigrated into India, fleeing persecution and receiving refuge
- (B) immigrated from her homeland and emigrated into India, fleeing refuge and receiving persecution
- (C) emigrated from her homeland and immigrated into India, fleeing refuge and receiving persecution
- (D) immigrated from her homeland and emigrated into India, fleeing persecution and receiving refuge

18. Tolerance and pluralism both appear in the chapter and are easily confused. The sharpest distinction is that tolerance names a _____ while pluralism names a _____.

- (A) social condition of many communities coexisting; personal attitude of respecting different beliefs
- (B) rejection of newcomers; rule of one community over the rest
- (C) personal attitude of accepting and respecting different beliefs; social condition of many communities coexisting in one society
- (D) system of medicine practised by a people; principal house of their worship

19. Match three terms to three meanings at once: cosmopolitan, tolerance, ethos. The fully correct set is:

- (A) cosmopolitan means a people's guiding spirit; tolerance means at home with many cultures; ethos means respecting different beliefs
- (B) cosmopolitan means at home with many cultures; tolerance means respecting different beliefs; ethos means a people's guiding spirit
- (C) cosmopolitan means respecting different beliefs; tolerance means a people's guiding spirit; ethos means at home with many cultures
- (D) cosmopolitan means a system of medicine; tolerance means a place of worship; ethos means a trade good

20. A student insists 'all communities in this chapter came to India by their own free choice.' Naming the single community that breaks this generalisation, and why, gives:

- (A) the Siddis, because they were brought enslaved rather than choosing to come
- (B) the Parsis, because they came to conquer rather than to choose settlement
- (C) the Arab merchants, because they were forced to come against their will
- (D) the Tibetans, because they came to rule rather than to take shelter

21. Two communities are each linked to a different century of arrival and a different motive. The Arab merchants and the Tibetan refugees are best summarised as:

- (A) Arab merchants came in the 1950s for refuge; Tibetans came in the 7th century for opportunity
- (B) both came in the 7th century, the Arab merchants for refuge and the Tibetans for opportunity

(C) both came in the 1950s, the Arab merchants for opportunity and the Tibetans for refuge

(D) Arab merchants came in the 7th century for opportunity; Tibetans came in the 1950s for refuge

22. A claim runs: 'Because India absorbed newcomers, those newcomers must have lost their distinct identities.' The chapter's strongest single rebuttal is that newcomers:

(A) maintained distinct places of worship and languages while living within Indian society

(B) each received their own territory to govern apart from Indian society

(C) all adopted one common religion and language after settling

(D) departed from India whenever their customs were questioned

23. The chapter offers borrowed foods, words, crafts and music as concrete proof. The proposition they prove is:

(A) a culture is destroyed whenever outsiders contribute to it

(B) outside contributions leave a culture entirely unchanged

(C) only trade goods, never culture, ever crossed into India

(D) mixing many communities makes a culture richer rather than poorer

24. Atithi devo bhava and vasudhaiva kutumbakam both express acceptance but differ in scope. The best statement of that difference is:

(A) the first treats the whole world as one family, while the second concerns only a single guest

(B) the first is a rule of trade, while the second is a rule of warfare

(C) the first honours the individual guest, while the second widens the circle to treat all humanity as one family

(D) the first applied only in ancient times, while the second applies only today

25. A student claims vasudhaiva kutumbakam is 'a museum piece with no use now.' The chapter's reasoned reply is that the ideal is relevant today BECAUSE:

(A) it instructs modern nations to rule over their neighbours as one family

(B) it guides traders alone in dealing with foreign partners

(C) it is preserved unchanged as a relic of antiquity with no present application

(D) peoples of many cultures increasingly live together, and treating the world as one family helps them coexist

26. Consider four communities at once: the Bene Israel, the Arab merchants, the Siddis and the Polish children. The statement that correctly sorts ALL of them by how they came is:

(A) all four came for opportunity through trade

(B) Bene Israel and Polish children came for refuge; Arab merchants for opportunity; the Siddis were brought enslaved

(C) Bene Israel and Arab merchants came for refuge; Siddis and Polish children for opportunity

(D) Bene Israel and Siddis came for refuge; Arab merchants and Polish children were enslaved

27. The Baha'is and the Tibetan refugees are paired in the chapter to make one particular point. That point is that India's tradition of acceptance:

(A) ended once the ancient communities had all arrived

(B) was offered only to communities that came to trade

(C) continued into modern times and reached across more than one faith

(D) applied to a single religion alone

28. A student says, 'The Syriac Christians prove Christianity reached India only with European rulers.' The most accurate correction is that they show Christianity:

(A) arrived only in the 20th century alongside European colonisers

(B) was first carried to India by the enslaved African Siddis

(C) is practised in India only by people of Armenian descent

(D) is very old in India, one of the world's oldest Christian communities having settled in Kerala long before European rule

29. What do the Syriac Christians and the Cochin Jews most precisely share, given that one is Christian and the other Jewish?

(A) both were brought to India enslaved and only later freed

(B) both arrived as conquering armies that ruled the regions they entered

(C) both abandoned their original religion soon after settling in India

(D) both are ancient communities that preserved their own faith while becoming part of Indian society

30. Among the Parsis, the Siddis and the Armenians, exactly one fits NEITHER the refuge nor the opportunity path. Naming it and stating what it reveals gives:

(A) the Parsis, revealing that some came purely to rule rather than to settle

(B) the Armenians, revealing that some arrived as conquering armies

(C) the Siddis, revealing that not every newcomer came by choice, since some were brought enslaved

(D) none of the three, revealing that every community fits neatly into the two paths

31. The Armenians and the Arab merchants are alike in the chapter for a reason that also distinguishes both from the Parsis. That shared feature is that the Armenians and Arab merchants:

(A) fled religious persecution as refugees

(B) came seeking opportunity through trade and settled in India

(C) were brought to India enslaved against their will

(D) arrived as refugees fleeing the dangers of a 20th-century war

32. The Armenians traded and settled in India yet built churches of their own. This best supports which claim about opportunity-seeking newcomers?

- (A) they always gave up their religion in exchange for trading rights
- (B) they never put down lasting roots where they did business
- (C) they kept their own faith and identity while becoming part of Indian society
- (D) they came only to conquer the regions in which they traded

33. A refugee and an opportunity-seeking immigrant both settle in India. The chapter locates their DEEPEST difference in:

- (A) the degree of choice, since the refugee is driven out by danger while the immigrant comes freely
- (B) whether they may keep their traditions, since only the immigrant is permitted to
- (C) whether they ever join Indian society, since only the immigrant truly does
- (D) the era to which each belongs, since refugees are ancient and immigrants modern

34. A Parsi family 'left Persia and settled in India.' Describing this from each country's viewpoint, the family has:

- (A) immigrated from Persia and emigrated into India
- (B) emigrated from Persia and immigrated into India
- (C) only emigrated, since a single move cannot also be an immigration
- (D) neither, because fleeing persecution is not a form of migration

35. Of the Cochin Jews, the Parsis and the Arab merchants, which one did NOT come seeking refuge, and what did it seek instead?

- (A) the Cochin Jews, who came seeking opportunity through trade
- (B) the Parsis, who came as conquerors seeking land
- (C) the Arab merchants, who came seeking opportunity through trade
- (D) none, because all three fled persecution

36. Persecution and refuge are linked but opposite in a refugee's story. The statement keeping them in the correct relationship is:

- (A) people flee refuge and seek persecution
- (B) people flee persecution and seek refuge
- (C) persecution is the shelter that a refugee is finally given
- (D) refuge and persecution mean exactly the same thing

37. Calling India a 'cosmopolitan' civilisation, in the chapter's sense, means precisely that it has:

- (A) welcomed only wealthy traders and turned the poor away
- (B) absorbed newcomers by erasing their original cultures
- (C) been at home with people of many cultures, like 'a citizen of the world'
- (D) stayed loyal to one single culture above all others

38. A people's 'ethos', as used in this chapter, refers to their:

- (A) characteristic spirit or guiding values, here acceptance and openness
- (B) traditional system of healing and medicine
- (C) principal house of worship and assembly
- (D) main goods carried along their trade routes

39. A student summarises the chapter in one line: 'Everyone came to India to trade, refugees lost their identities, and diversity weakened the culture.' How many claims are correct, and what is the best overall correction?

- (A) all three claims are correct as stated
- (B) only the 'refugees lost their identities' claim is correct
- (C) none are correct; many came as refugees or enslaved, communities kept their identities, and diversity enriched the culture
- (D) only the 'diversity weakened the culture' claim is correct

40. A textbook captions a photo of a fire temple as 'a Jewish house of worship in Kerala built by traders.' Three things are wrong. The fully corrected caption reads:

- (A) a Jewish house of worship in Gujarat built by a refugee community
- (B) a Zoroastrian house of worship in Kerala built by traders
- (C) a Zoroastrian (Parsi) house of worship, associated mainly with Gujarat, built by a refugee community
- (D) a Christian house of worship in Gujarat built by enslaved arrivals

41. A claim states: 'Since the Siddis are recognised as a scheduled tribe today, they must have come to India freely, like other recognised communities.' The flaw is that scheduled-tribe status:

- (A) describes present constitutional protection and says nothing about how a community originally arrived
- (B) is granted only to communities that came freely as traders or refugees
- (C) proves a community was never enslaved at any point
- (D) is the same as being a foreign trading guild with special rights

42. Two communities are each tied to a specific knowledge-or-faith contribution. Sowa Rigpa and India's oldest mosque belong, respectively, to:

- (A) the Tibetan refugees and the Arab merchants
- (B) the Arab merchants and the Tibetan refugees
- (C) the Parsis and the Siddis
- (D) the Siddis and the Armenians

43. A student reasons: 'The Parsis kept their fire temples, so they must have stayed apart; the Mappila married locals, so they must have lost their identity.' The chapter shows BOTH inferences are too extreme because:

- (A) both communities integrated into Indian society while keeping their own identities, avoiding both total apartness and total assimilation
- (B) the Parsis truly stayed apart, while the Mappila truly lost their identity

- (C) the Parsis lost their identity, while the Mappila stayed entirely apart
- (D) both communities abandoned their faiths to become fully Indian

44. Which of these correctly identifies the ONE pairing of community-to-motive that is accurate, where the other three each misfile a community?

- (A) Siddis — opportunity through trade (B) Tibetans — refuge from danger
- (C) Parsis — opportunity through trade (D) Arab merchants — refuge from persecution

45. A visitor says, 'India only recently began letting outsiders in.' The fact that most directly overturns this, with the right reason, is:

- (A) the Tibetan refugees arrived in the 1950s, showing openness began only in the 20th century
- (B) the Baha'is are a modern community, proving India opened only in recent times
- (C) Arab merchants reached the west coast as early as the 7th century, showing India has received newcomers for well over a thousand years
- (D) the Siddis' scheduled-tribe recognition is recent, so acceptance itself is recent

46. The chapter's two-path model says newcomers came either for refuge or for opportunity. The single best statement of WHY the Siddis are the clearest exception is:

- (A) they came to conquer rather than to seek refuge or trade
- (B) they were the only community that refused to settle in India
- (C) they are the only community whose religion the chapter calls ancient
- (D) they were brought enslaved, so they chose neither path

47. A student lists 'synagogue, fire temple, church, monastery, mosque' and asks which house of worship the chapter does NOT tie to a settling newcomer community in India. The best answer is:

- (A) the monastery, which is not among the houses of worship the chapter assigns to its newcomer communities
- (B) the synagogue, since the Jews are not treated as newcomers
- (C) the fire temple, since the Parsis built no places of worship
- (D) the mosque, since Arab merchants left no buildings

48. Consider the Cochin Jews, the Armenians, the Siddis and the Tibetans. The statement that correctly sorts ALL FOUR by how they came to India is:

- (A) all four came for opportunity through trade
- (B) Jews and Armenians came for refuge; Siddis and Tibetans came for opportunity
- (C) Siddis and Tibetans came for refuge; Jews and Armenians were brought enslaved
- (D) Jews and Tibetans came for refuge, Armenians for opportunity, and the Siddis were brought enslaved

49. A student argues that the Good Maharaja's act and the Tibetan welcome both belong to the SAME value as India's recognition of the Siddis as a scheduled tribe. The most precise correction is that:

- (A) the Good Maharaja and the Tibetan welcome both express giving refuge to those fleeing danger, while the Siddi recognition expresses extending protection to a community that arrived enslaved
- (B) all three are identical examples of giving refuge to people fleeing danger
- (C) all three are examples of welcoming traders who came for opportunity
- (D) the Good Maharaja and the Siddi recognition are about refuge, while the Tibetans came for trade

50. The chapter describes diversity using foods, words, crafts, music and faiths. A student asks which of these proves that even RELIGIOUS practice, not just material goods, enriched India. The strongest single example is:

- (A) the borrowing of foods into everyday Indian meals
- (B) the survival and practice of faiths such as Zoroastrianism, Judaism and Christianity within India
- (C) the entry of new words into Indian languages
- (D) the spread of new crafts among Indian artisans

51. A student writes: 'The Parsis fled persecution, settled in Gujarat, kept their fire temples, and worship Ahura Mazda taught by the prophet Zarathushtra.' Identifying the number of accurate elements gives:

- (A) three are accurate; the Parsis settled mainly in Kerala, not Gujarat
- (B) two are accurate; the Parsis worship Zarathushtra, not Ahura Mazda
- (C) one is accurate; the Parsis came to trade, not to flee persecution
- (D) all four elements are accurate

52. India hosting Jews, Parsis, Syriac Christians, Muslims and Baha'is together over centuries, each keeping its own faith, is in the chapter's vocabulary an example of:

- (A) persecution, the ill-treatment of communities for their beliefs
- (B) assimilation, the merging of all communities into one common identity
- (C) enslavement, the bringing of communities against their will
- (D) pluralism, the peaceful coexistence of many communities and faiths in one society

53. A speaker says, 'India should keep out all foreigners to protect its culture.' The value from this chapter that most directly contradicts the argument, and the reason, is:

- (A) scheduled-tribe recognition, because it shows India bars outsiders
- (B) the rule that newcomers must repay hospitality through trade
- (C) the principle that newcomers must abandon their own faith to settle
- (D) vasudhaiva kutumbakam, because treating the world as one family means welcoming newcomers rather than excluding them

54. Three communities are listed: the Parsis, the Polish children and the Tibetans. The single label that correctly fits ALL three is:

- (A) they all came to India seeking opportunity through trade
- (B) they all came to India seeking refuge from persecution or danger
- (C) they were all brought to India enslaved against their will
- (D) they all arrived in India only in the 20th century

55. A student claims the Bene Israel, the Cochin Jews and the Mappila are 'all Jewish communities of India.' The precise correction is that:

- (A) all three are indeed Jewish communities that built synagogues
- (B) the Bene Israel and Cochin Jews are Jewish, but the Mappila is a Kerala Muslim community formed by Arab settlers marrying locals
- (C) all three are Kerala Muslim communities formed by Arab settlers
- (D) the Bene Israel are Muslim, while the Cochin Jews and Mappila are Jewish

56. The chapter's overall verdict on India's diversity of communities, stated with the value that frames it, is best given as:

- (A) a source of strength and richness, in the spirit of vasudhaiva kutumbakam
- (B) a weakness that left India vulnerable to outsiders
- (C) a problem best solved by removing minority communities
- (D) a matter of no real importance to India's story

57. A timeline question: which sequence correctly orders these by the chapter's sense of EARLIEST to LATEST as Indian phenomena — the founding of Zoroastrianism, the peaceful arrival of Islam via Arab merchants, the Tibetan refugees' arrival?

- (A) the Tibetans arrived first, then Islam arrived, and Zoroastrianism was founded last
- (B) Zoroastrianism is one of the world's oldest religions, Islam arrived peacefully from the 7th century, and the Tibetans arrived in the 1950s
- (C) Islam arrived in the 7th century, Zoroastrianism was founded after it, and the Tibetans came in between
- (D) all three belong to the 20th century and cannot be ordered

58. A student concludes: 'Because India welcomed so many faiths, it must have a single official religion that absorbed the others.' The chapter contradicts this because India's pattern was:

- (A) every newcomer faith merging into one shared Indian religion
- (B) each faith being replaced by the religion of the most powerful community
- (C) newcomers being forced to give up their faiths to remain in India
- (D) many faiths coexisting peacefully while each kept its own identity, not absorption into one religion

59. Finally, a student offers a 'balanced' summary: 'Some communities fled danger and some came to trade, but in the end all were absorbed and lost their distinct ways, which is why Indian culture stayed unchanged.' Identifying which parts are right and wrong gives:

- (A) the whole summary is correct as a balanced account
- (B) the refuge-and-trade split is wrong, but the absorption and unchanged-culture claims are right
- (C) the refuge-and-trade split is right, but communities kept their distinct identities and diversity changed Indian culture by enriching it
- (D) everything is wrong, including the idea that any community came for refuge or trade

60. A student argues, 'The chapter's examples of acceptance are all ancient, so they cannot show that India's openness still operates.' The Baha'i community is offered as a counter precisely because it shows that acceptance:

- (A) applied only to communities that had arrived in ancient times
- (B) reached a faith that arose in modern times, demonstrating India's openness continued beyond the ancient communities
- (C) was extended only to communities that came to trade for profit
- (D) required each new faith to merge into one shared Indian religion

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 17: India, a Home to Many — Paper 5

Paper 5 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	A	11	D	21	D	31	B	41	A	51	D
2	A	12	C	22	A	32	C	42	A	52	D
3	A	13	B	23	D	33	A	43	A	53	D
4	D	14	A	24	C	34	B	44	B	54	B
5	B	15	C	25	D	35	C	45	C	55	B
6	B	16	B	26	B	36	B	46	D	56	A
7	D	17	A	27	C	37	C	47	A	57	B
8	C	18	C	28	D	38	A	48	D	58	D
9	C	19	B	29	D	39	C	49	A	59	C
10	D	20	A	30	C	40	C	50	B	60	B

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (A) The chapter's repeated pattern is identity-preserving integration: synagogues, fire temples and churches were kept WHILE the community became part of Indian society, so a separate house of worship signals belonging-with-identity, not enforced apartness. The option about being forced to abandon faith inverts the evidence, since the very survival of the building proves the faith was kept. The 'ruled from its own quarter' option imports conquest, which the chapter does not attach to these settled communities. The 'only modern times' option contradicts the premise the student already granted, that India received the community for over a thousand years.

2. (A) Arab merchants reached the west coast from the 7th century and the Siddis were brought enslaved from roughly the 7th century onward, both ancient; the Tibetan refugees are a 20th-century (1950s) arrival, so the modern case comes last. The first wrong option puts a 1950s arrival first, reversing the order. The second misreads the Siddi span by treating its 19th-century end as its start. The fourth places the Siddis after the 1950s Tibetans, contradicting their 7th-century-onward arrival.

3. (A) The 'world is one family' ideal is matched in the chapter to the concrete enrichment of Indian life by borrowed foods, words, crafts, music and faiths, directly answering the 'purity' argument. The atithi-devo-bhava option misstates the evidence, since newcomers KEPT their customs rather than dropping them. The tolerance option falsely says the Siddis were held apart, when they were drawn into Indian society and constitutionally protected. The pluralism option invents expulsions the chapter never describes.

4. (D) The Parsis fled religious persecution and the Polish children fled war, so both fall under refuge; the Armenians came chasing trade, which is opportunity; and the Siddis fit neither path because they were brought enslaved. Treating all four as traders erases the refugee and enslaved cases entirely. Pairing Armenians with danger misfiles a trading community. The last option correctly groups Parsis and Polish children but wrongly turns the enslaved Siddis into traders.

5. (B) The chapter dates the peaceful Arab-merchant arrival to the 7th century, far earlier than the military invasions, which is exactly why they are distinct events. Saying the invasions came first reverses the timeline. Denying the peaceful arrival contradicts India's oldest mosque, the physical proof of that early trade. Calling them the same moment in two descriptions collapses the centuries-long gap the chapter insists on.

6. (B) The mosque marks where Arab merchants peacefully settled in the 7th century, evidencing that faith spread through trade and settlement before any invasions. The conquest option contradicts the peaceful nature of that settlement. The Siddi option misattributes the mosque to a different, enslaved community. The Parsi option confuses Zoroastrian refugees with the Arab-merchant Muslims and invents a conversion the chapter never mentions.

7. (D) The Mappila community formed peacefully as Arab merchants settled and married into local families, while the Siddis were brought against their will as enslaved people, so the contrast is free settlement versus enslavement. The first wrong option simply swaps the two. The 'armies' option imports conquest into communities the chapter describes as forming through trade or enslavement. The 'refugees' option misfiles both, since neither began as religious refugees.

8. (C) A community brought enslaved later gained constitutional recognition and protection, showing acceptance reached even those who came by force, which is the strongest version of the chapter's openness theme. The 'only freely arriving' option excludes exactly the enslaved case that makes the point. The 'permanently outside' option is the opposite of scheduled-tribe recognition. The 'usefulness in trade' option invents a transactional test the chapter never applies.

9. (C) Scheduled-tribe status is constitutional recognition giving a community special support and protection, which fits the Siddis. The trading-guild option confuses protection with commercial privilege. The 'barred from settling' option is the reverse of recognition

and protection. The 'ruling dynasty' option mistakes a protected community for a governing power.

10. (D) The Cochin Jews, Syriac Christians and Parsis all arrived by choice and kept their faiths within Indian society, whereas the Siddis came enslaved, so the 'came of their own accord and kept their faith' sentence distinguishes them. The enslaved option describes the Siddis, the very community the sentence must exclude. The 20th-century-war option fits the Polish children, not these ancient settlers. The abandoned-religion option contradicts the surviving synagogues, churches and fire temples.

11. (D) Zoroastrianism is among the oldest religions, worships the one God Ahura Mazda, and teaches choosing good over evil, so all three facts hold. The 'newest, many gods' option fails on both age and the single-God point. The 'branch of Judaism' option misclassifies the faith and borrows the synagogue, which is Jewish. The last option wrongly makes the human prophet Zarathushtra into the God, when the God is Ahura Mazda.

12. (C) The two errors are treating the prophet Zarathushtra as God and treating a deity as the builder of the fire temples; the corrections are that Ahura Mazda is the one God and the Parsi community built its own fire temples. The first wrong option keeps the God/prophet confusion, merely reassigning the temple-building to a deity. The 'many gods' option contradicts Zoroastrianism's single-God teaching. The last option simply swaps the prophet and God, leaving the error intact.

13. (B) The Parsis settled mainly in Gujarat and are marked by fire temples, while the Cochin Jews are marked by synagogues, so this pairing is correct. The first wrong option swaps the two markers and misplaces the Parsis in Kerala. The Tibet/monastery pairing belongs to the Tibetan community, not these two. The Armenia/church pairing attaches Armenian and Christian markers to communities that are Zoroastrian and Jewish.

14. (A) Synagogue is Jewish, the fire temple is Parsi (Zoroastrian), the church is Christian as with the Armenians, and India's oldest mosque marks the Arab merchants, so this set is fully correct. Each wrong option scrambles at least two pairings, for example assigning the synagogue to the Parsis or the mosque to the Tibetans or Parsis, none of which the chapter supports.

15. (C) A refugee community's healing system becoming part of India's official medical framework directly disproves the idea that refugees add nothing or weaken the host culture. The 'ever sheltered refugees' option is refuted by the act of giving the Tibetans refuge, not by Sowa Rigpa specifically. The 'religion not medicine' option misreads Sowa Rigpa, which is itself the 'Art of Healing'. The 'came for trade' option targets a motive question, not the enrichment misconception the AYUSH fact answers.

16. (B) Both the Polish children and the Tibetans were given refuge from danger, making refuge the shared thread. The Arab-merchant link fails because the Polish children did not

come to trade. The Siddi link fails because the children were refugees, not enslaved. The Armenian link fails because the connection is about giving shelter, not about building churches.

17. (A) Leaving a country is emigrating and entering one is immigrating, so she emigrated from home and immigrated into India; being attacked for her beliefs is persecution and the shelter she got is refuge. The first wrong option reverses both migration terms and swaps persecution with refuge. The second keeps the right migration direction but flips persecution and refuge. The fourth keeps the right emotions but reverses emigrate and immigrate.

18. (C) Tolerance is the attitude of accepting and respecting different beliefs, while pluralism is the societal state of many communities living together, so attitude versus condition is the right split. The first wrong option swaps the two definitions. The 'rejection/rule of one' option describes the opposites of both ideas. The 'medicine/worship' option defines neither term and borrows ideas (Sowa Rigpa, places of worship) from elsewhere in the chapter.

19. (B) Cosmopolitan is being at home with many cultures ('a citizen of the world'), tolerance is respecting different beliefs, and ethos is a people's guiding spirit, so this set matches all three. The first and second wrong options rotate the three meanings among the wrong words. The last option swaps in unrelated meanings drawn from medicine, worship and trade.

20. (A) The Siddis were brought enslaved, the one community that did not come by choice, so they break the generalisation. The Parsis chose to flee persecution and did not conquer. The Arab merchants came freely for trade, not by force. The Tibetans chose to flee danger and did not come to rule, so only the Siddi case fits.

21. (D) Arab merchants reached India in the 7th century seeking trade (opportunity), while the Tibetans arrived in the 1950s fleeing danger (refuge), so this matches both century and motive. The first wrong option swaps both communities entirely. The second wrongly dates the Tibetans to the 7th century and flips the motives. The third wrongly dates the Arab merchants to the 1950s.

22. (A) The survival of distinct synagogues, fire temples, churches and languages alongside membership in Indian society is the clearest evidence that identity was kept, refuting 'absorbed therefore lost.' The 'own territory to govern' option describes separation, not the integration the chapter shows. The 'one common religion and language' option is precisely the loss of identity being refuted. The 'departed' option contradicts these communities' long settlement in India.

23. (D) Everyday borrowed foods, words, crafts and music are cited as evidence that diversity enriches a culture, the chapter's central verdict. The 'destroyed' option is the

misconception the evidence is meant to refute. The 'unchanged' option ignores that these borrowings visibly altered Indian life. The 'only trade goods' option denies cultural transfer, which the borrowed words and music directly contradict.

24. (C) 'Atithi devo bhava' is about honouring the guest as God, the narrower idea, while 'vasudhaiva kutumbakam' broadens this to the whole world as one family. The first wrong option simply reverses which phrase has the wider scope. The 'trade/warfare' option misreads both as transactional or military slogans. The 'ancient/today' option invents a time split the chapter does not draw, since both are presented as enduring values.

25. (D) The chapter ties the ideal's modern relevance to the reality that diverse peoples must coexist, where 'one family' thinking helps. The 'rule over neighbours' option twists family unity into domination. The 'traders alone' option narrows a universal value to commerce. The 'relic with no application' option simply restates the student's mistaken claim rather than rebutting it.

26. (B) The Jewish Bene Israel and the Polish children both came fleeing danger (refuge), the Arab merchants came for trade (opportunity), and the Siddis were brought enslaved, so this sorting is complete and correct. Calling all four traders erases two distinct paths. The second option misfiles the Arab merchants as refugees and the Polish children as traders. The third wrongly enslaves the Arab merchants and Polish children while overlooking the actually enslaved Siddis.

27. (C) Both the Baha'is and the Tibetans are recent arrivals of differing faiths, showing acceptance persisted into modern times across faiths. The 'ended after ancient times' option is contradicted by these very modern examples. The 'only traders' option fails because the Tibetans came as refugees, not traders. The 'single religion' option is disproved by pairing two different faith communities.

28. (D) The Syriac Christians are one of the world's oldest Christian communities, settled in Kerala in ancient times, which refutes the 'only with Europeans' claim. The '20th century with colonisers' option restates the error. The 'enslaved Siddis carried it' option invents a route the chapter never describes and confuses two different communities. The 'only Armenians' option wrongly restricts Indian Christianity to one ancestry.

29. (D) Despite different faiths, both are old communities that kept their religion while joining Indian society, the chapter's recurring pattern. The 'enslaved' option fits the Siddis, not these settlers. The 'conquering armies' option imports conquest the chapter does not attach to them. The 'abandoned religion' option contradicts their long-preserved faiths.

30. (C) The Siddis came enslaved, fitting neither refuge nor opportunity, and this reveals the limit of the two-path model. The Parsis fit refuge, so they are not the exception, and they did not come to rule. The Armenians fit opportunity and did not arrive as armies. The 'none of the three' option ignores the very enslaved case that breaks the model.

31. (B) Both the Armenians and the Arab merchants came for trade (opportunity) and settled, which also sets them apart from the refugee Parsis. The 'fled persecution' option actually describes the Parsis, not these traders. The 'enslaved' option fits the Siddis. The '20th-century war refugees' option fits the Polish children, none of which describe the two trading communities.

32. (C) Trading Armenians building churches shows that even opportunity-seekers kept their faith and identity while integrating. The 'gave up religion for trading rights' option is refuted by the churches themselves. The 'never put down roots' option is contradicted by their settling and building. The 'came to conquer' option imports a military motive the chapter does not assign to traders.

33. (A) The defining contrast is choice: the refugee is forced out by danger or persecution while the immigrant comes freely seeking opportunity. The 'keep traditions' option is false because both kept their identities. The 'join society' option is false because refugees like the Parsis fully joined Indian society. The 'era' option invents a time split, since both refugees and traders appear across ancient and modern times.

34. (B) Leaving Persia is emigration and entering India is immigration, so both terms apply from opposite viewpoints. The first wrong option reverses the directions. The 'only emigrated' option denies that one move counts from both sides. The 'neither' option wrongly excludes forced flight from migration, when refugees clearly migrate.

35. (C) The Arab merchants came for trade (opportunity), while the Jews and Parsis both fled persecution (refuge), so the Arab merchants are the non-refugee case. Calling the Cochin Jews traders misfiles a persecuted community. Calling the Parsis conquerors contradicts their flight from persecution. The 'none' option falsely groups the Arab traders with the two refugee communities.

36. (B) Persecution is the ill-treatment fled and refuge is the shelter sought, so 'flee persecution, seek refuge' is correct. The first wrong option reverses the two. The second wrongly redefines persecution as shelter. The 'same thing' option erases the opposition between the danger and the safety.

37. (C) Cosmopolitan means being at home with many cultures, the 'citizen of the world' idea. The 'only wealthy traders' option adds a wealth filter the term does not carry. The 'erasing cultures' option is the opposite of the chapter's identity-preserving model. The 'single culture' option contradicts the very meaning of cosmopolitan.

38. (A) Ethos means a people's guiding spirit, which the chapter identifies as acceptance and openness. The 'system of healing' option describes Sowa Rigpa. The 'house of worship' option describes a synagogue or temple. The 'trade goods' option confuses ethos with commerce.

39. (C) All three claims fail: many came as refugees (Parsis, Polish children, Tibetans) or enslaved (Siddis) rather than to trade, communities kept their identities through their houses of worship and languages, and diversity enriched rather than weakened Indian culture. The 'all three correct' option endorses three refuted claims. The two single-claim options each accept one misconception the chapter explicitly overturns.

40. (C) A fire temple is Zoroastrian (Parsi), the Parsis are linked to Gujarat not Kerala, and they were refugees rather than traders, so all three errors are fixed only in the correct caption. The first option fixes the location and motive but keeps the wrong 'Jewish' faith. The second fixes the faith but keeps Kerala and the trader error. The third changes the faith to Christian and adds an enslaved-origin error.

41. (A) Scheduled-tribe recognition is about present protection, not original arrival, so it cannot imply the Siddis came freely; in fact they were brought enslaved. The 'only freely arriving' option invents an eligibility rule the chapter never states. The 'never enslaved' option contradicts the Siddis' enslaved origin. The 'trading guild' option confuses constitutional protection with commercial privilege.

42. (A) Sowa Rigpa is the Tibetan healing system and India's oldest mosque marks the Arab merchants, so this pairing is correct. The first wrong option swaps the two. The Parsi/Siddi pairing attaches neither contribution to its real community. The Siddi/Armenian pairing likewise misassigns both items.

43. (A) The chapter's balance is integration-with-identity for all these communities, so neither the 'stayed apart' nor the 'lost identity' extreme holds; the Parsis joined Indian society while keeping fire temples, and the Mappila kept their Muslim faith while marrying locally. The first option endorses both extremes. The second swaps them but keeps both errors. The 'abandoned their faiths' option contradicts the surviving fire temples and the enduring Mappila Muslim identity.

44. (B) The Tibetans fled danger, so 'refuge from danger' is accurate. The Siddis were brought enslaved, not trading for opportunity. The Parsis fled persecution rather than seeking trade. The Arab merchants came for trade, not refuge, so only the Tibetan pairing fits.

45. (C) The 7th-century Arab-merchant arrival proves India received newcomers over a thousand years ago, directly refuting 'only recently.' The Tibetan-1950s option actually supports the visitor's mistaken idea. The Baha'i option likewise points to a modern arrival rather than an ancient one. The Siddi-recognition option confuses a recent legal status with the much older arrival, since the Siddis themselves came centuries ago.

46. (D) The Siddis came enslaved, exercising neither the refuge nor the opportunity choice, which is exactly why they are the exception. The 'conquer' option assigns a military motive the chapter never gives them. The 'refused to settle' option is false, since the Siddis

settled and were later recognised. The 'ancient religion' option confuses the exception's basis with a faith-age claim that does not apply.

47. (A) The chapter ties synagogues to Jews, fire temples to Parsis, churches to Christians like the Armenians, and the oldest mosque to Arab merchants, but does not assign a monastery to a newcomer community, so the monastery is the odd one out. The synagogue option wrongly denies the Jews are newcomers. The fire-temple option falsely claims the Parsis built nothing. The mosque option ignores India's oldest mosque, the very building tied to the Arab merchants.

48. (D) The Jews and Tibetans fled danger (refuge), the Armenians came to trade (opportunity), and the Siddis were brought enslaved, so this fourfold sorting is correct. Treating all as traders erases refuge and enslavement. The second option misfiles the Armenians as refugees and the enslaved Siddis as traders. The third wrongly enslaves the Jews and Armenians while turning the enslaved Siddis into refugees.

49. (A) Sheltering the Polish children and the Tibetans are both refuge acts, but the Siddi recognition is a distinct act of protecting an enslaved-origin community, so the three are not the same value. The 'all identical refuge' option wrongly folds the enslaved Siddis into the refugee cases. The 'all traders' option misfiles every example as opportunity-seeking. The last option correctly separates one case but wrongly turns the Tibetan refugees into traders.

50. (B) Faiths like Zoroastrianism, Judaism and Christianity taking root in India shows religious, not merely material, enrichment. Borrowed foods, words and crafts each illustrate material or linguistic enrichment rather than the religious dimension the question asks about, so they are weaker answers to this specific point even though all are valid examples of diversity's contribution.

51. (D) Every element is correct: the Parsis fled persecution, settled mainly in Gujarat, kept fire temples, and worship the one God Ahura Mazda as taught by the prophet Zarathushtra. The Kerala option falsely relocates them. The 'worship Zarathushtra' option repeats the God/prophet confusion. The 'came to trade' option misfiles refugees as traders.

52. (D) Many faiths coexisting peacefully while keeping their identities is pluralism. Persecution is the opposite, the ill-treatment people flee. Assimilation would mean merging into one identity, which contradicts the kept-faith picture. Enslavement names how the Siddis arrived, not the coexistence of many faiths.

53. (D) 'The whole world is one family' directly opposes shutting foreigners out, making it the contradicting value. Scheduled-tribe recognition is about protecting communities, not barring outsiders, and is misdescribed here. The 'repay hospitality through trade' rule is invented and contradicts atithi devo bhava. The 'abandon their faith' principle is the opposite of the chapter's identity-preserving acceptance.

54. (B) The Parsis fled persecution while the Polish children and Tibetans fled the dangers of war and conflict, so refuge fits all three. The 'opportunity through trade' label fits none of them. The 'enslaved' label fits the Siddis, not these refugees. The '20th century only' label fails because the Parsis arrived in ancient times.

55. (B) The Bene Israel and Cochin Jews are India's Jewish communities, while the Mappila is a Muslim community formed when Arab merchants married locally, so the grouping is two Jewish and one Muslim. The 'all Jewish' option wrongly includes the Mappila. The 'all Muslim' option wrongly excludes the actual Jewish communities. The last option misassigns the Bene Israel as Muslim and the Mappila as Jewish.

56. (A) The chapter judges diversity a source of strength and richness, framed by the 'world is one family' ideal. The 'weakness' option is the misconception the chapter refutes with its enrichment evidence. The 'remove minorities' option contradicts the entire spirit of acceptance. The 'no importance' option dismisses what the chapter treats as central to India's identity.

57. (B) Zoroastrianism is among the oldest religions in the world, Islam's peaceful arrival dates to the 7th century, and the Tibetans came in the 1950s, giving the oldest-to-newest order. Placing the 1950s Tibetans first reverses the sequence. Founding ancient Zoroastrianism after 7th-century Islam contradicts its standing as one of the oldest religions. Lumping all three into the 20th century ignores the ancient items entirely.

58. (D) India's pattern is pluralism, many faiths coexisting while keeping their distinct identities, the opposite of absorption into one religion. The 'merging into one' option is the very absorption the chapter denies. The 'replaced by the powerful' option contradicts the survival of minority faiths. The 'forced to give up faiths' option is refuted by the enduring synagogues, fire temples and churches.

59. (C) The summary's first half is right, since some fled danger (and one was enslaved) while others came to trade, but its second half is wrong because communities kept their identities and their diversity actively enriched rather than left unchanged Indian culture. Accepting the whole summary endorses the false absorption and unchanged claims. Rejecting the refuge-and-trade split discards a correct distinction. Calling everything wrong denies the genuine refuge and trade motives the chapter describes.

60. (B) The Baha'is are a relatively modern faith community, so India's acceptance of them shows openness continued past the ancient arrivals, refuting the 'all ancient' claim. The 'only ancient communities' option restates the very error the Baha'i example overturns. The 'only traders' option fails because the Baha'is illustrate acceptance across faiths, not a trade test. The 'merge into one religion' option contradicts the chapter's pattern of each faith keeping its own identity.